

CRICKET

Page 1 — Introduction to Cricket

Cricket is a bat-and-ball sport played between two teams. Each team normally has eleven players.

The batting team tries to score runs, while the bowling and fielding team tries to prevent runs and dismiss batters.

A cricket match can be played in several formats, including Test cricket, One Day Internationals, and Twenty20 cricket.

Cricket combines individual skills with teamwork. Batters need timing, bowlers need accuracy, and fielders need speed and concentration.

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Page 2 — The Cricket Pitch

The cricket pitch is the rectangular area in the center of the field. It is 22 yards long, or 20.12 meters, between the two wickets.

A wicket consists of three stumps with two bails placed on top. There is one wicket at each end of the pitch.

The batter stands near a crease while facing the bowler. The crease helps define the batter's safe area.

The pitch condition can influence how the ball behaves and may help fast bowlers, spin bowlers, or batters.

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Page 3 — Batting and Scoring Runs

The main goal of batting is to score runs. A batter can score by running between the wickets or by hitting boundaries.

If the ball reaches the boundary after touching the ground, the batting team normally receives four runs. A clean hit over the boundary normally scores six.

Common batting shots include the drive, pull, cut, sweep, and defensive stroke.

Good batting requires balance, timing, footwork, concentration, and an understanding of the match situation.

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Page 4 — Bowling and Fielding

The bowling team tries to dismiss batters and restrict the number of runs scored.

Fast bowlers use speed, movement, bounce, and changes of pace. Spin bowlers use rotation to make the ball turn after pitching.

Batters can be dismissed in several ways, including bowled, caught, lbw, run out, and stumped.

Fielders stop boundaries, save runs, and take catches. Field placement changes according to the batter, bowler, and match situation.

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Page 5 — Cricket Formats

Test cricket is the longest international format. A Test match can last up to five days and gives each team the opportunity to bat twice.

One Day International cricket traditionally gives each team fifty overs. It combines long-term planning with controlled scoring.

Twenty20 cricket, commonly called T20, gives each team twenty overs and is designed to be fast and high-intensity.

Different formats require different strategies. Test cricket emphasizes patience, while T20 emphasizes rapid scoring and specialist roles.

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Page 6 — Strategy and Spirit of Cricket

Cricket is not only about individual performance. Teams make decisions about batting order, bowling changes, field placement, and when to take risks.

A captain studies the score, wickets, overs remaining, pitch conditions, and strengths of the players before choosing tactics.

Communication and teamwork are essential. Players must support one another and make quick decisions during important moments.

The spirit of cricket emphasizes fairness, respect, discipline, and sportsmanship. These qualities make cricket a rich subject for studying strategy and decision-making.